VMO2 App Library Design System

A shared Figma Variables library that keeps 3 app teams consistent.

Role
- Design systems
- Component strategy
- UX implementation

Team
- Design
- Engineering
- Design system lead

Timeline
6 months. Transitioning onto wider Creative Design System

Platform
- Figma
- My O2 App
- My VM App
- Priority App

01 Challenge

Teams were recreating similar components across brands, creating inconsistent states and design-to-development drift. My role was to help shape a scalable cross-brand system, then put it into practice by creating the My O2 App master file and implementing the new variable structure.

02 Constraints

The system needed to support three brands, existing live journeys and inconsistent legacy components while moving designers from Tokens Studio to native Figma Variables.

I had to balance standardisation with enough flexibility for different product needs, while resolving variable, publishing and component conflicts as the system evolved.

03 Finding the friction

Data used
7,609 recorded component inserts, used to estimate time saved.

Research
Audit of repeated patterns and inconsistent component states across the apps..

Key insight
Many components could be consolidated into shared foundations rather than rebuilt per brand.

04 Exploring options

Compared the existing Tokens Studio workflow with native Figma Variables. Variables enabled native theming and reduced reliance on third-party tooling

05 The design

Atomic foundations
Rebuilt components from atomic foundations using Figma Variables.

Aligned with code
Worked with engineering so component and variable logic reflected how the UI was built.

Prove it in practice
Created the My O2 App master file and was the first to implement the new variables in a live app design file.

06 Outcome and next steps

Across 7,609 recorded component inserts, the new approach was estimated to save 5–6 hours per designer each year while creating a more scalable cross-brand foundation.

Next, learnings from the App Library will feed into the wider CDS, shaping shared variable structures, component patterns and governance across Virgin Media and O2.

Next case study→
Product Card Research

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